



infinity and *beyond*

What's the biggest
number you can think of?

Whatever answer you come up with, you can always add 1. Then you can add 1 again, and again, and again ... In fact, there's no limit to how big (or how small) numbers can get.

The word mathematicians use for this
endlessness is **infinity**.

An *infinite* amount
of time is called an
eternity

the symbol for infinity looks like a figure 8 on its side

How long is
an infinite distance?

Imagine you can run a
million miles an hour and you
spend a *billion lifetimes* running
non-stop in a straight line. By the end
of your run, you'd be **no closer**
to infinity than when you started.



Concepts like infinity and eternity are very difficult for the human mind to comprehend – they're just *too big*. To picture how long an eternity lasts, imagine a single ant